



- Unlike other pronouns, such as *you*, *he*, *she*, *it*, and *them*, *I* is **always spelled** with a **capital letter**.

The English alphabet **originally only had capital letters**. Lowercase letters were introduced in the **eighth century CE**.



Identifying when to use capital letters

It's important to use capital letters correctly so it's clear where one sentence ends and another begins. Proper nouns must also be capitalized, so that the names of people or places, or expressions of time, can be easily distinguished from other common things.

All the capital letters are used correctly here.

my friend pia traveled to france on thursday. ❌

My



A sentence must begin with a capital letter.

Pia



Names of people always have a capital letter.

France



Names of countries begin with a capital letter.

Thursday



Days of the week always begin with a capital letter.

My friend Pia travelled to France on Thursday. ✅

San Francisco, the rain drenched friends at the Katwalk Café.

People and places

Proper nouns, such as the names of people or places, always begin with a capital letter. A capital letter is also required when describing a specific place, such as "the South," which may refer to the southern region of a country. However, capital letters are not required when indicating a general direction, as in "north of the shopping center."

San Francisco

A city requires a capital letter. For cities with two parts, both words are capitalized.

Olivia

The name of a person must be capitalized.

River Nile

Both parts of this specific river name are capitalized.

Katwalk Café

Both parts are capitalized as they form the name of a place of business.

Disneyland

This is the name of a place, so it is capitalized.

Africa

Names of continents are capitalized.